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are in the textiles, tourism, energy, food processing and pharma sectors.

CLAIMS DON'T ADD UP

The Yogi government claims projects worth Rs 3 lakh crore are now off the ground, and these have led to 500,000 new jobs. But then, unemployment was a major poll issue in the recent assembly election. Opposition parties challenge the government's claims on investment, with Congress MLC Deepak Singh saying, "The government does not have the data on total investment and total number of jobs created. I asked a question in the state legislative council a couple of years ago about this, and the industrial development minister replied that the department is still collecting that data. Now they come up with a claim that projects worth Rs 3 lakh crore have started, but they can't show us the details of the projects. If such a big amount has been invested, why are there so many people looking for jobs in the state?"

Samajwadi Party spokesperson Ashutosh Verma also alleges that the government is liberally window-dressing the investment figures. "This government has spent thousands of crores on investment meets and GBC events, but they don't have the figures for the jobs created by these projects. They also can't provide the break-ups of the total figure (Rs 3 lakh crore investment). This BJP government only believes in doing publicity events," he says.

INDIA TODAY did get some data from the CM's office on the investment projects related to the top industrialists but the break-up for the Rs 3 lakh crore figure remained elusive. UP's industrial development commissioner and other top officials were also contacted, but they too did not respond. Nand Gopal Nandi, the state minister of industrial development, counters the opposition charge, saying they don't want to see the positive changes in the state in the past five years. But he also could not provide credible data on the numbers. "In any state, a positive environment and strict enforcement of law and order are necessary for investment. In the past five years, we have seen many projects worth Rs 3 lakh crore in the cooperative, animal husbandry, food processing, housing, electronics, textiles and MSME sectors."

The Yogi government's claims, though, will get a boost with the latest figures from the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE) survey, which says UP had one of the lowest unemployment rates among the states—2.9 per cent—in April, down from 4.4 per cent in March. Dr A.P. Tiwari, a senior UP-based economist, says, "There have been investments in infrastructure, food processing, IT, health sector etc. and the business environment has also improved through the proactive policies of the Yogi government, but they should focus on transparency and accountability in terms of facts and figures. UP has immense scope for investment...if utilised well." Therein lies the root of the problem; hopefully, Yogi has found a solution for it. ■

INDIA INC IS LOOKING AT UP ANEW

Total worth of MoUs signed at 2018 UP Investors' Summit

Rs 4.7 lakh crore

Second ground-breaking ceremony in 2019 saw launch of 290 projects worth

Rs 67,000 crore

Plans for third ground-breaking ceremony: 2,000 projects worth

Rs 70,000 crore

Source: CM's office, Lucknow

> **"THE STATE HAS BEEN PROACTIVE IN RESOLVING THE ISSUES OF INVESTORS, WHICH IS WHY EVEN DURING THE COVID PHASE UP GOT INVESTMENTS WORTH Rs 65,000 CRORE"**
>
> **NAND GOPAL NANDI**
> *Minister of Industrial Development, UP*

